# Module Interface Specification for Software Engineering

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# 1 Revision History

| Date | Version | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Date 1 | 1.0 | Notes |
| Date 2 | 1.1 | Notes |

# 2 Symbols, Abbreviations and Acronyms

See SRS Documentation at [give url —SS]

[Also add any additional symbols, abbreviations or acronyms —SS]

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# 3 Introduction

The following document details the Module Interface Specifications for [Fill in your project name and description —SS]

Complementary documents include the System Requirement Specifications and Module Guide. The full documentation and implementation can be found at .... [provide the url for your repo —SS]

# 4 Notation

[You should describe your notation. You can use what is below as a starting point. —SS]

The structure of the MIS for modules comes from Hoffman and Strooper (1995), with the addition that template modules have been adapted from Ghezzi et al. (2003). The mathematical notation comes from Chapter 3 of Hoffman and Strooper (1995). For instance, the symbol := is used for a multiple assignment statement and conditional rules follow the form $(c_1 \Rightarrow r_1|c_2 \Rightarrow r_2|...|c_n \Rightarrow r_n)$.

The following table summarizes the primitive data types used by Software Engineering.

| Data Type | Notation | Description |
|---|---|---|
| character | char | a single symbol or digit |
| integer | $\mathbb{Z}$ | a number without a fractional component in (-$\infty$, $\infty$) |
| natural number | $\mathbb{N}$ | a number without a fractional component in [1, $\infty$) |
| real | $\mathbb{R}$ | any number in (-$\infty$, $\infty$) |

The specification of Software Engineering uses some derived data types: sequences, strings, and tuples. Sequences are lists filled with elements of the same data type. Strings are sequences of characters. Tuples contain a list of values, potentially of different types. In addition, Software Engineering uses functions, which are defined by the data types of their inputs and outputs. Local functions are described by giving their type signature followed by their specification.

# 5 Module Decomposition

The following table is taken directly from the Module Guide document for this project.

| **Level 1** | **Level 2** |
|---|---|
| Hardware-Hiding | |
| Behaviour-Hiding | Input Parameters<br>Output Format<br>Output Verification<br>Temperature ODEs<br>Energy Equations<br>Control Module<br>Specification Parameters Module |
| Software Decision | Sequence Data Structure<br>ODE Solver<br>Plotting |

Table 1: Module Hierarchy

# 6 MIS of [Module Name —SS]

[Use labels for cross-referencing —SS]

[You can reference SRS labels, such as R??. —SS]

[It is also possible to use LaTeXfor hypperlinks to external documents. —SS]

## 6.1 Module

[Short name for the module —SS]

## 6.2 Uses

## 6.3 Syntax

### 6.3.1 Exported Constants

### 6.3.2 Exported Access Programs

| Name | In | Out | Exceptions |
|---|---|---|---|
| [accessProg —SS] | - | - | - |

## 6.4 Semantics

### 6.4.1 State Variables

[Not all modules will have state variables. State variables give the module a memory. —SS]

### 6.4.2 Environment Variables

[This section is not necessary for all modules. Its purpose is to capture when the module has external interaction with the environment, such as for a device driver, screen interface, keyboard, file, etc. —SS]

### 6.4.3 Assumptions

[Try to minimize assumptions and anticipate programmer errors via exceptions, but for practical purposes assumptions are sometimes appropriate. —SS]

### 6.4.4 Access Routine Semantics

[accessProg —SS]():

- transition: [if appropriate —SS]
- output: [if appropriate —SS]

- exception: [if appropriate —SS]

[A module without environment variables or state variables is unlikely to have a state transition. In this case a state transition can only occur if the module is changing the state of another module. —SS]

[Modules rarely have both a transition and an output. In most cases you will have one or the other. —SS]

### 6.4.5 Local Functions

[As appropriate —SS] [These functions are for the purpose of specification. They are not necessarily something that is going to be implemented explicitly. Even if they are implemented, they are not exported; they only have local scope. —SS]

# References

Carlo Ghezzi, Mehdi Jazayeri, and Dino Mandrioli. *Fundamentals of Software Engineering*. Prentice Hall, Upper Saddle River, NJ, USA, 2nd edition, 2003.

Daniel M. Hoffman and Paul A. Strooper. *Software Design, Automated Testing, and Maintenance: A Practical Approach*. International Thomson Computer Press, New York, NY, USA, 1995. URL http://citeseer.ist.psu.edu/428727.html.

# 7 Appendix — Generative AI Use Disclosure

[ChatGPT (version 5) was used to brainstorm ideas for the template for this disclose section. —SS]

## 7.1 AI Tools Used

[Give the name of the AI tool(s) used and the version. —SS]

## 7.2 How and Where Used

[Explain what the tool(s) were used for. Examples include: brainstorming, explaining a technical concept, reviewing the document, generating or modifying text, generating or modifying diagrams, identifying errors or omissions or inconsistencies. —SS]

[For each of the uses, identify which parts of the document were affected. —SS]

[You do not need to report every interaction, but you should disclose the uses that materially contributed to your work —SS]

## 7.3 Verification of AI-Generated Content

[

- Describe how the team checked AI-generated or AI-assisted material before including it in the document.
- In particular, verify factual claims, technical assertions, requirements, calculations, references, and other information for which an AI system may produce incorrect or fabricated results.
- **The team is responsible for the accuracy, completeness, consistency, and appropriateness of the submitted document, regardless of whether material was generated by a human or an AI system.**

—SS]

# 8 Appendix — Reflection

[Not required for CAS 741 projects —SS]

The information in this section will be used to evaluate the team members on the graduate attribute of Problem Analysis and Design.

The purpose of reflection questions is to give you a chance to assess your own learning and that of your group as a whole, and to find ways to improve in the future. Reflection is an important part of the learning process. Reflection is also an essential component of a successful software development process.

Reflections are most interesting and useful when they're honest, even if the stories they tell are imperfect. You will be marked based on your depth of thought and analysis, and not based on the content of the reflections themselves. Thus, for full marks we encourage you to answer openly and honestly and to avoid simply writing "what you think the evaluator wants to hear."

Please answer the following questions. Some questions can be answered on the team level, but where appropriate, each team member should write their own response:

1. What went well while writing this deliverable?

2. What pain points did you experience during this deliverable, and how did you resolve them?

3. Which of your design decisions stemmed from speaking to your client(s) or a proxy (e.g. your peers, stakeholders, potential users)? For those that were not, why, and where did they come from?

4. While creating the design doc, what parts of your other documents (e.g. requirements, hazard analysis, etc), it any, needed to be changed, and why?

5. What are the limitations of your solution? Put another way, given unlimited resources, what could you do to make the project better? (LO_ProbSolutions)

6. Give a brief overview of other design solutions you considered. What are the benefits and tradeoffs of those other designs compared with the chosen design? From all the potential options, why did you select the documented design? (LO_Explores)

7. (After you have implemented another team's module, which means this isn't filled in until after the original deadline). What did you learn by implementing another team's module? Were all the details you needed in the documentation, or did you need to make assumptions, or ask the other team questions? If your team also had another team implement one of your modules, what was this experience like? Are there things in your documentation you could have changed to make the process go more smoothly for when an "outsider" completes some of the implementation?

Your reflection should be about concepts learned in your SE education, such as modular decomposition, cohesion, coupling, information hiding, etc. You should critique the quality and utility of the specification you received.

You should create a PR for your implemented module. A link to the PR should be part of your reflection.